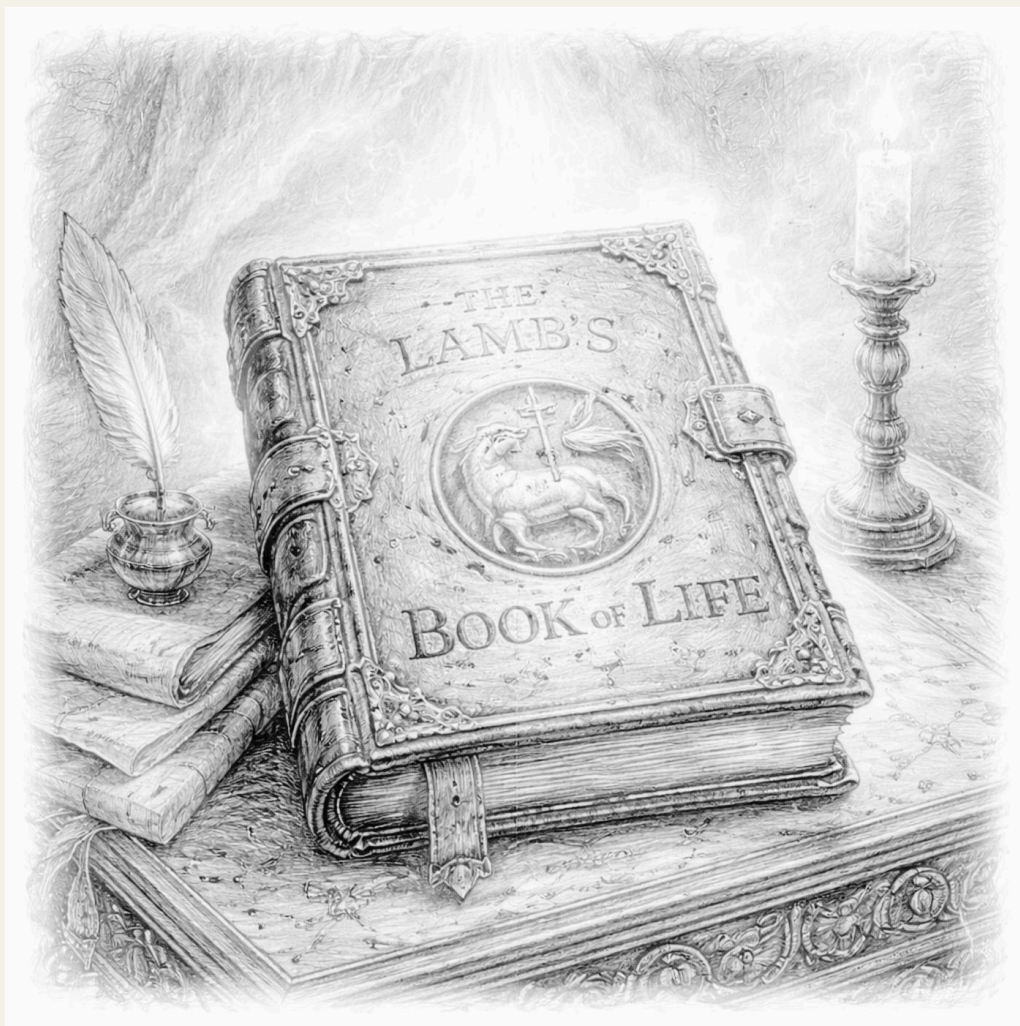


Election



The Lamb's Book of Life, shut with a clasp, a quill and a candle beside it. Names in a book the readers did not write. Light falls on the cover.

Before you gather

- Read Day 30, Election, in The Visual Gospel. Do not reteach the essay.
- Read Deuteronomy 7:6–8 and Romans 8:29–30 in your Bible. The excerpt below is only a backup.

- Your people should already have answered the day's reflection questions. Do not ask those again.
- Leave with a name. The missional challenge only works if someone is named before you pray.

1 · ICEBREAKER · 7 MIN

Open the room

What story do you love in which, by the end, you see the ending was prepared from the first page?

Leader. A prepared ending. The book already asked about peace in storms, and about names not erased in Revelation 3:5. Leave both alone. Say that passing is allowed, especially the first few weeks.

2 · THE WORD · 8 MIN

See it, then say it

IF YOU NEED THE WORDS

Say: Election means God chose a people in Christ before the foundation of the world, in love, to be holy. Not because we were better. The book in the drawing is the Lamb's book. We did not write the names. That is why this story was never fragile.

DEFINITION, FROM THE BOOK

Election is God's choice, made before the world began, to save people through Jesus, not because they earned it or were better than others, but because of His love and mercy.

IN THE ORIGINAL LANGUAGE

Greek eklegomai — to choose, to pick out, to call one's own.

MEMORY VERSE · EPHESIANS 1:3–4

Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who has blessed us in Christ with every spiritual blessing in the heavenly

places, even as he chose us in him before the foundation of the world, that we should be holy and blameless before him.

Together, open the flashcard for Election. Say the word, the definition, and the verse once. Then put the phone away.

3 · OPEN THE BIBLE · 15 MIN

Deuteronomy 7:6–8 and Romans 8:29–30

Deuteronomy 7 tells Israel they were not chosen for being impressive. Romans 8:29–30 walks the chain from foreknowledge to glory. Use it to look back over thirty weeks. Do not turn the night into a debate, and do not retake a final exam.

For you are a people holy to the LORD your God. The LORD your God has chosen you to be a people for his treasured possession, out of all the peoples who are on the face of the earth. It was not because you were more in number than any other people that the LORD set his love on you and chose you, for you were the fewest of all peoples, but it is because the LORD loves you and is keeping the oath that he swore to your fathers. For those whom he foreknew he also predestined to be conformed to the image of his Son... And those whom he predestined he also called, and those whom he called he also justified, and those whom he justified he also glorified.

Have two readers if you can. Bibles open. The excerpt is only here so a forgotten Bible does not stop the night.

From the passage

1. In Deuteronomy 7, what reason for His choice does God refuse, and what reason does He give? **CORE**

Leader. Not because they were more in number. Because the Lord loves them and keeps the oath He swore. Election empties boasting. Ephesians 1:4–5: chosen in Christ, in love, before the foundation of the world, not because we were better.

2. Walk Romans 8:29–30 slowly. Which words from these thirty weeks do you hear inside that chain?

Leader. Foreknown, predestined, conformed to the image of His Son, called, justified, glorified. Let them connect what they have learned. Do not force every word to fit. Christ holds the chain. God gave the growth, and He will finish it.

4 · AROUND THE ROOM · 20 MIN

A conversation this chapter did not assign

3. Ephesians 1:4 says He chose us in Him, in Christ, that we should be holy. How does “in Christ” keep election from becoming either pride or paralysis? **CORE**

Leader. Pride says, “I was the better one.” Paralysis says, “I cannot know, so I will not come.” Look at Christ, not at a secret list in your head. We were not chosen because a future faith made us attractive, or because we were better. We are chosen in Him.

4. John 6:37: “All that the Father gives me will come to me, and whoever comes to me I will never cast out.” What does the second half do to the fear that election locks the door on someone who wants in?

Leader. The rule of the door is this: whoever comes to Jesus, He will never cast out. Election explains why anyone comes. It is not a guard against the willing. Say it clearly. This is the pastoral center of the night. Do not open a debate.

5. You have thirty words. Using any five, with no notes for a moment, how would you tell a friend what God has done in Jesus? One minute. Clumsy is fine.

Leader. This sends them. Listen. Encourage. Add only what they dropped if it was the cross, or the call to repent and believe. Do not grade vocabulary. If the group is large, use pairs. The sentence has to name Christ.

5 · SAY IT · 5 MIN

In one sentence

Election is God’s choice, before the world began, to save a people in Christ, out of love, not because they were better.

Ask for two volunteers, not the whole circle. They may look at the sentence, then try it without looking. Clumsy and true is the goal.

6 · THIS WEEK · 5 MIN

Missional challenge

Before next week, carry this word to someone far from Jesus — a neighbor, a classmate, a coworker, a friend. Do it with a real action and with a true sentence. Name the person before you pray.

Go to the person you would have skipped, the one easy to forget. Pray for them, serve them, and invite them to Christ. Say His welcome out loud: whoever comes to Jesus, He will never cast out.

Leader. Do not explain election on the porch. Election is why you go to the person you would have skipped. Keep John 6:37 in your mouth, and name Christ. Next week, before the icebreaker, take one minute. Who went, and what happened? One sentence. No speeches.

7 · PRAY · 8 MIN

Pray these, and leave room for others

1. Bless the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, in the words of Ephesians 1:3–5 if you can.
2. Thank Him that He chose a people in love, in Christ, not because they were better.
3. Ask for courage to say the gospel in ordinary words this week, and pray for one name.

Before you stumble

This word has split rooms. Your job is not to win a system, and not to host a debate. Say what these texts say. Refuse what they do not. They do not say God is cruel, or that He delights in rejecting people. They do not say we were chosen because we were better, or because a future faith made us attractive. They do

say love, Christ, holiness, and a real human coming to Jesus. If someone is angry, do not mock them. Give them John 6:37. If someone is proud, Deuteronomy 7 is the cure. If someone fears they are not chosen, the test is not a feeling about eternity past. The test is whether they will come to Christ. Whoever comes, He will never cast out. End the thirty weeks with praise, not an argument. A last line you can use: the Lamb's book is His, the blood is His, the welcome is His, and it is open to all who come.

WITH STUDENTS

Skip the debate labels. Ask: if God loved you for being ahead of the class, what happens when you fall behind? Then read Deuteronomy 7:7–8 in words they can hear. He did not pick you for being more. He loves you, and He chose a people in Christ.

IF YOU STILL HAVE TIME

Revelation 21:27 beside John 6:37. Only those written in the Lamb's book of life enter the city. And whoever comes to Jesus, He will never cast out. Leave both in their hands: a real book, and a real welcome. Then go.